

4.5% of Malta's energy from burning waste?

WasteServ's figures for the Magħtab waste-to-energy plant, tested against Eurostat and the NECP

THE CLAIM

“It is expected to meet around 4.5% of Malta's total energy needs.”

WasteServ, ECOHIVE news, 26 June 2023

Same item: the plant “will be treating around 192,000 tonnes of non-recyclable waste”. In 2020: “4.5% as green energy”.

Data: Eurostat energy balances (retrieved 10 Oct 2026) and Malta's National Energy and Climate Plan (Dec 2024).

VERDICT

MISLEADING

4.5% fits electricity; of all Malta's energy it is about 1.1–1.8%.

SUPPORTED

LARGELY
SUPPORTED

NOT
SUBSTANTIATED

MISLEADING

CONTRADICTED

MAIN RESULTS

4.5%

WasteServ's figure

The plant would meet “around 4.5% of Malta's total energy needs”. WasteServ gave no method or year.

126 GWh

Electricity a year

WasteServ's own output figure; it matches the NECP design (14–16 MW net, about 24% efficient).

4.4–4.7%

Share of electricity, 2022

Where 4.5% fits: 126 GWh against Malta's electricity use in the year before the statement.

1.5%

Share of all energy, 2022

126 GWh against final energy consumption (1.2% of primary energy); about three times smaller.

3.2%

Electricity share, 2030

Against the NECP's projected supply. The NECP does not count the plant as renewable.

FAIR TO SAY

The tonnage (192,000 t) and the output (126 GWh) agree with the Government's own energy plan, and 4.5% is a fair figure for electricity. The problem is the word “total”.

WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT

☐ WasteServ: the calculation behind the 4.5%.

☐ WasteServ: will the plant supply heat, and how much?

☐ WasteServ or ERA: the EIA's energy balance.

☐ Ministry: the January 2025 parliamentary answer.